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The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, not as warm, clouds and sunshine, an afternoon thunderstorm, high 80. **Tonight**, turning cloudy, low 57. **Tomorrow**, much cooler, clouds, high 67. Weather map, Page B10.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



Displaced people Thursday in Lebanon. Outside of the truce’s time frame, there was little clarity on what was expected of the two sides.

ISRAEL APPROVES PAUSE FOR 10 DAYS IN LEBANON FIGHT

**Cease-Fire Could Aid U.S.-Iran Talks —
Hezbollah’s Position Is Uncertain**

This article is by Euan Ward, Isabel Kershner, Eric Schmitt and Thomas Fuller.

BEIRUT, Lebanon — A 10-day cease-fire between Israel and Lebanon went into effect on Friday, a pause in fighting that has the potential to remove a major hurdle in the broader peace talks between Iran and the United States.

President Trump announced the cease-fire hours earlier, saying that he had spoken to the leaders of both countries and that he would invite them to the White House for “meaningful talks.” Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu confirmed the agreement, and Prime Minister Nawaf Salam of Lebanon said his country welcomed the cease-fire.

At an impromptu news conference later Thursday, Mr. Trump said he was optimistic that he could reach a separate peace agreement with Iran, which has called for Lebanon to be part of any long-term deal to end the war there. He said he might travel to Pakistan if a deal was signed there.

Mr. Trump also said he would consider extending the cease-fire now in effect with Iran if a broader agreement appeared near.

But with the fate of both cease-fires intertwined, the outlook for the one in Lebanon remained shrouded in uncertainty.

The talks that led to the agreement between Israel and Lebanon’s governments did not involve Hezbollah, the Iranian-backed militant group that Israel is fighting. Although Hezbollah has signaled that it will abide by the truce, Lebanon’s government has little control over the group, which it has accused of operating at Tehran’s behest.

Mr. Netanyahu presented the cease-fire as an opening for diplomacy to forge what he called “a historic peace agreement with Lebanon.” But he emphasized that progress depended on the disarmament of Hezbollah — a goal that has long eluded Israel and the Lebanese government.

Rocket fire and drone launches toward northern Israel continued up until the final minutes before the cease-fire came into effect at midnight local time, and the Israeli military said it was striking launchers from which the rockets were fired. In the previous 24 hours, the military struck what it described as more than 380 Hezbollah targets in southern Lebanon, it said.

The cease-fire deal came after a long day of negotiating. At one point before it was announced, according to one Lebanese official, Lebanon’s president, Joseph Aoun, rebuffed attempts by the Trump administration to agree to a phone call with Mr. Netanyahu.

Mr. Trump provided the time frame of the truce — 10 days — but little clarity on the terms, or what is expected of the two sides.

Last month, after coming under fire from Hezbollah, Israel invaded a broad area of southern Lebanon.

Continued on Page A8

Trump Casts Iran War as Won and Done. Reality Won’t Comply.

By ANTON TROIANOVSKI

WASHINGTON — President Trump is trying to cast his Iran war as all but over, a done-and-dusted success.

But after years of trying to impose his own reality on the world, he has now run into a crisis that is not bending to his narrative.

“It’s a new regime,” Mr. Trump said in a Fox Business interview that aired on Wednesday, referring to Iran’s new leaders. “We find them pretty reasonable, to be honest with you, by comparison

pretty reasonable.”

It was the latest instance of Mr. Trump’s trying to spin a “regime change” accomplishment in Iran, even though analysts believe that the war may have only increased the internal sway of the Islamic Revolutionary Guards Corps, the hard-line military force that has long been a major player in Iran’s politics and economy.

The new supreme leader, Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei, has not been seen in public since he replaced his father, who was killed at the start of the war, but his elevation as head of state has been an-

President Faces a Crisis and a Country His Will Can’t Bend

other symbol of continuity.

“Most generously you could say there is a leadership change,” said Behnam Ben Taleblu, the senior director of the Iran program at the Foundation for Defense of Democracies, a Washington think tank with a hawkish stance on Iran. “It is incorrect for the proponents of

the conflict to frame this as a change for the better.”

Indeed, trade through the Strait of Hormuz remains far from normal, and Iran’s government is not bending to Mr. Trump’s demands on its nuclear program.

But in Mr. Trump’s telling, U.S. victory in Iran is already clear. In the Fox Business interview, reprising his frequent comments of the last two weeks, Mr. Trump asserted that Iran’s navy, air force and antiaircraft equipment had all been wiped out, along with many top officials. If Iran did not rule out

Continued on Page A8

Nun’s Last Mission Is to Let Go After a Life of Caring for Others

By KURT STREETER

The blinds were half-drawn, softening the July light to a gray wash. Lavender lotion and disinfectant hung in the air. Around the bed, a small circle of nuns had gathered — women from the Sisters of Charity of New York, an order that helped shape the city for two centuries and was now nearing its end.

Sister Anna had curled into herself, bracing against pain the morphine could not reach. When an aide stepped forward to straighten her legs, Sister Mary Kay Finneran spoke with the authority of someone who had watched too many bodies fail.

“Leave her be,” she said. “That should have been done two months ago. Now, just let her be.”

Mary Kay had spent days praying a single line: Please God, take her home, take her home.

They were on the ninth floor of

the Kittay Senior Apartments, a subsidized housing tower in the Bronx. While the rest of the building was a bustle of secular city life, the ninth floor felt like a world apart, a small community of the order’s most infirm sisters, women who needed tending as they tended to one another.

Anna was a woman of few possessions — one crucifix, one rosary — but her devotion was full. Years ago, when Mary Kay was too sick to leave her room, on oxygen and unable to get to Mass, Anna had brought her communion every day, without being asked.

She and Mary Kay lived across the hall from each other, trading jokes about the food and, if devotions of the hour called for it, sitting together in silence. Every Sunday at 3, Anna telephoned her

Continued on Page A18



Sister Mary Kay Finneran bringing communion to another nun in the Bronx building where some of her order’s members live.

As Triumphal Arch Keeps Getting Bigger, So Does the Backlash

By LUKE BROADWATER and ZACHARY SMALL

WASHINGTON — During his first term, President Trump visited the Arc de Triomphe in Paris to attend a commemoration of Armistice Day, which ended World War I. The memory of the arch stayed with him, and eight years later, he is determined to surpass it.

“The one that people know mostly is the Arc de Triomphe in Paris, France, and we’re going to top it by, I think, a lot,” Mr. Trump said in December of his plans to build his own triumphal arch in Washington. “The only thing they have is history.”

Mr. Trump now wants to build a 250-foot-tall arch on the other side of the Potomac River from the Lincoln Me-

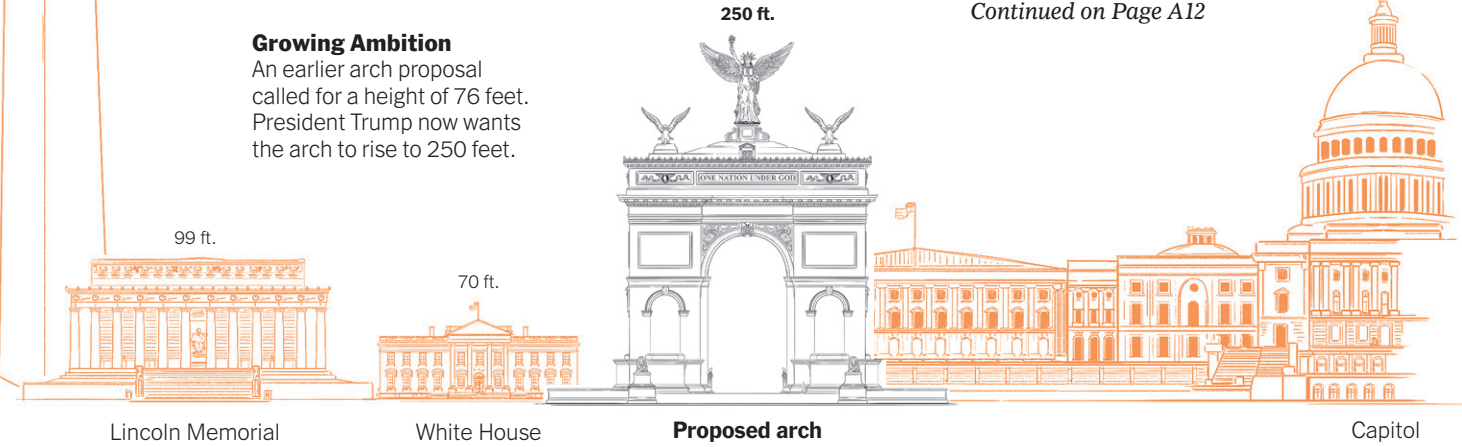
morial. If it is approved as drawn, with statues on top, it will be 50 percent taller than the Arc de Triomphe.

But Mr. Trump’s push to build the giant arch — more than quadrupling its size from original plans — has alienated early proponents of the project, classical architects and veterans groups who say it will diminish nearby Arlington Cemetery.

It has even alarmed Catesby Leigh, an architecture critic who encouraged Mr. Trump to build a triumphal arch, most recently in a 2025 article in The American Mind, an online magazine of the Claremont Institute, a right-wing think tank.

“Washington is the only major Western capital without a monumental arch,” Mr. Leigh wrote. He cautioned that the arch need not be “huge” and that it should stand no taller

Continued on Page A12



MARCO HERNANDEZ/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Love Story With Roots in 1950s France Leads to an ICE Lockup

By NICHOLAS BOGEL-BURROUGHS and CATHERINE PORTER

A few years ago, Marie-Thérèse Ross-Mahé reconnected with a man named Bill Ross, whom she had met when she was a young secretary and he was stationed in France for the U.S. military. Both widowed and in their 80s, the two fell in love, and last year she moved more than 4,000 miles to Anniston, Ala., to marry him.

But the trans-Atlantic love

story soured in January after Mr. Ross died, setting off an ugly inheritance battle between his two sons and Ms. Ross-Mahé, 85. This month, immigration agents arrested her in her nightgown at her late husband’s home — and a county probate judge overseeing his estate said that one of his sons was responsible for the arrest.

Ms. Ross-Mahé is now in a federal detention center hundreds of miles away in Louisiana. Her own three children back in France have been unable to reach her

Widow, 85, Is Detained Amid Probate Fight

there and fear for her health.

The Calhoun County probate judge, Shirley A. Millwood, a Republican elected in 2024, in a ruling last Friday urged the federal government to investigate, “especially in light of the ongoing national events surrounding the dis-

trust of federal law enforcement officers and the many investigations ongoing of corruption within our government.”

She appointed an independent administrator for Mr. Ross’s estate and temporarily ordered his sons to give up their keys to their father’s home. The ruling has not previously been reported.

Judge Millwood wrote in her ruling that she believed that Mr. Ross’s younger son, Tony Ross, who she said was a retired Ala-

Continued on Page A14

NATIONAL A10-20

Senate Votes to Allow Mining
Environmentalists have warned that a proposed mine upstream from a Minnesota wilderness could devastate fragile lakes and forests. PAGE A20

A Mystery of Faith
A Gallup poll found a sharp rise in men under 30 who said that religion was “very important” to them: 42 percent in 2025, from 28 percent in 2023. PAGE A11

Ex-Lt. Gov. Kills Wife and Self
Justin Fairfax was a lieutenant governor for Virginia from 2018 to 2022. The couple’s children were home at the time of the killings, the police said. PAGE A16

INTERNATIONAL A4-9

Vow to Keep Supporting Kyiv
Despite the recent focus on the Iran war, European leaders said it was crucial to keep aid flowing to Ukraine. PAGE A6

Finding a Haven in the Tropics
In the Costa Rican mountains, a Quaker village is a sanctuary for families expelled by the U.S. government. PAGE A4



BUSINESS B1-5

Leadership Limbo
An investigation into chair Jerome H. Powell is blocking a smooth transition at the Federal Reserve. PAGE B1

Reframing the A.I. Debate
A.I.’s common sense may still be a bit lacking, but it can help predict what jobs it may replace. PAGE B1

OBITUARIES A21

Author of Addiction Memoir
Barbara Gordon’s “I’m Dancing as Fast as I Can” (1979) detailed years of prescription drug abuse and critiqued American psychiatry. She was 90.

WEEKEND ARTS C1-10

Math Girl, Interrupted
Ayo Edebiri stars as a haunted genius in “Proof” — a revival exposing the play’s lack of rigor, Helen Shaw writes. PAGE C1

Take a Look at the Locals
“Greater New York,” an exhibition featuring artists living and working in the city, arrives with energy. PAGE C1



SPORTS B6-9

The Courting of a Closer
The Dodgers made Edwin Díaz feel wanted when they signed him away from the Mets in December. PAGE B6

Quick’s Case for the Hall
Jonathan Quick, the winningest American-born goalie in N.H.L. history, was at his best in the playoffs. PAGE B7

OPINION A22-23

Jessica Grose PAGE A22

